

Becoming a dom • Chapter 1

# Build a persona

Last checked 3 November 2026 • 9 minutes to read

A persona is a character with a rulebook. This chapter shows how to write the rules, the voice and the look down before the first post, and where persona design starts to pull on the people it serves.

Vivian's field notes | Unverified

## In 30 seconds

- A persona is a written file: name, tone, marks, voice rules, look and limits.
- The limits and the wall between character and person are written first, before any money moves.
- The authority is performed. Harshness is a role, and it can be on request only.
- Entry rules, prices and ranks are persuasion. Say every condition before the first send.
- Pace matters: a persona that depends on one tired person is fragile.

*You will learn*

- What goes into a persona file, and in what order to write it.
- How a voice and a look stay recognisable.
- Which limits to write down, and why they are written and not remembered.
- How entry rules and ranks look from the sub's chair.
- How to keep the pace without burning out.

> A persona is a costume with a rulebook. I wrote mine down before anyone paid me anything, and that is why it holds on a tired evening. Write yours first, and let the file decide what happens at night, not the mood.
>
> — Vivian

## What a persona is

A persona is a character that someone builds, writes and keeps. In 2DFD it has a name, a look, a voice, a set of rules and a story, and it is the whole of what a sub meets. ◑ What is 2DFD? explains the game. This chapter is for the person who builds the character.

The authority is performed. The dominant manner a dom shows in public is a role, and the same person may be gentle, or even submissive, in private. Many personas present as pure doms and keep any other side off the main account, so a stated role should be read as costume and never as a fact about the person. ◑

A strong persona does not guarantee an audience. In my experience, how far a post travels depends at least as much on whether the platform pushes it as on

the character, and a month in is too early to judge results. Whether some characters attract more than others has not been measured. Unverified

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**Vivian's field notes**

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## The persona file

Write the persona into one file before you post anything. The file makes the character repeatable across a site, posts, chat and tools, and it makes you consistent when you are tired.

## What goes in the file

1 **Name and tone**

A name, one sentence of tone and a short bio. Vivian is cold, possessive and never vulgar.

2 **Marks**

A mark of the universe such as a seal or a colour, a sign-off, a welcome line for returning visitors and a line that says play has manners.

3 **House voice**

Fixed rules for how she writes, listed below.

4 **Limits**

What she never does, written in full. See Limits and the wall, below.

5 **Look recipe**

The few features that make her recognisable, written so anyone can reproduce them.

Vivian's voice rules are short enough to learn by heart.

- Two short sentences, the second turned toward him.
- One praise word at most per screen.
- She never shouts, and exclamation marks and emoji stay out.
- Insults and threats stay out.
- Never vague about money.

The voice reaches the buttons. A generic label such as “pay now” felt wrong in her mouth, so the wording was drafted in voice first: plain and confident, never cute. All public text is in one language, and a stray line in another language reads as a leak.

New doms usually learn a voice by imitating someone, and that is fine for a while. The risk is sounding like a copy, so let the voice drift toward the character you are building. Taste in writing is part of identity: choose and defend your lines, and do not hand the voice over wholesale to a machine.

Tutorial

# Build a persona in three steps

## 1 Decide what you show

Face or no face, voice or no voice, and what you never show.

*Do this.* Write three lists: always, sometimes, never.

*Common mistake.* Showing something once that you cannot take back.

## 2 Write your rules first

The cap each sub sets for himself, what you never do, how a sub stops. All of it before the first message.

*Do this.* Write your stop word and your cap rule in one short paragraph.

*Common mistake.* Writing the rules after the first send.

## 3 Choose one platform

Learn its rules on gifts and refunds before you share a link.

*Do this.* Read the platform's page on gifts and refunds, start to finish.

*Common mistake.* Opening five accounts at once.

# Look and signs

A persona is recognised at thumbnail size, so write the look as a recipe: hair, eye colour, ears, one accessory, and always an adult. Consistency of the recipe matters more than any single image. One signature look repeated across content is easier to recognise than many looks, and a seasonal look works best as a layer on top that can be switched on and off.

The style has to fit the dominance the persona performs. Soft, cute styles read as sweet, and a commanding register usually needs a more mature look. The owner lives with the style every day, so the owner's taste decides. A friend's taste is an opinion. If the images come from another person, agree in writing who owns them and who is credited before they spread.

Many personas are built on an existing character, and the studio that made the design keeps it. See Art for your persona.

Small repeating signs make a world. A signature phrase at the end of a session, stickers and emotes made from the character, short dance loops, one colour and a small vocabulary of file numbers and stamps all do it. A lore frame such as a court or a cult makes the calls to action easy to write. It can also make a send feel like loyalty, so read it as theatre, with the cap as the only ceiling.

Myth

### A persona is a person.

Fact

A persona is a role with a script. Her authority, her harshness and even her stated nature belong to the costume. ◑

Myth

### A strong picture makes a strong persona.

Fact

The recipe, the voice and the rules carry the character. Reach depends largely on whether the platform pushes the post. ◑

## Limits and the wall

Limits live in the file and not only in your head. ◑ Vivian’s file says what she never does.

- Meet in real life.
- Use a camera.
- Use her voice.
- Appear as a minor or as anything child-like.
- Do scat or gore.
- Chase anyone.
- Cross a sub’s real limits.

The hardest line is the first one. Anything that touches real life is a no, and talk of meeting is refused. Never confirm a real-life detail about the person behind the persona, and keep the story closed. That wall is what protects both sides. See Stay anonymous.

*Never chase.* The sub comes to the persona, and she does not follow up. This keeps the relationship voluntary and removes the pressure that follow-ups create. When someone asks you to stop messaging, stop.

*Harshness is a role.* A dom with a gentle nature can find a cruel tone hard to play, because it can feel like real cruelty. The answer is that it is performance, many subs ask for it, and you return to yourself afterwards. A persona can be soft by default and sharp only on request.

*Rules come before money.* A first sub should meet the frame before the first send: what the persona keeps, what she throws out, her limits and how to stop. A list of what she throws out belongs to the act. Keep it about behaviour, such as haggling or wasting time, and never about a sub's money troubles.

The person who is paid cannot be the safety net. If a sub says money is short, the money part stops for that evening. If he says he is in trouble, you stop, listen, ask for nothing more and point outward: emergency services, a helpline, someone physically near him. See Where to get help.

### A sub says rent is short

A sub who usually sends a little tells you that rent is short this month. He wants to send anyway “to make it up to you”. What do you do?

**A** Pause the money for the evening, thank him, and point to outside help if he sounds in trouble

*The right answer.* Right. A hardship statement stops the money, and the person who earns from him cannot be his safety net.

**B** Accept this once, since he offered

*Not this one.* The offer does not change the cost. If he is wrong about his budget, he pays for it and you profit.

**C** Ask him to prove it before you decide

*Not this one.* A proof test turns a worry into a negotiation. Believe the statement and stop the money.

## Entry rules and pressure designs

A persona is also a funnel, and a funnel is persuasion. A persona that is warm in voice but hard about money is still hard about money. Safe design often means earning less.

Some doms ask for a small fixed send to get in. In my experience it draws many people and many leave quickly, while adding conditions such as a session or two draws fewer people who stay longer. Some keep the public step low and explain further conditions in private. I would state every condition before the first send, because a condition that appears after the money moved is a pressure design.

On time, some doms cap chat with contacts who never send at about an hour a day, and others ignore unknown messages. Both are choices about time, and neither changes how fast a sub can stop.

Here is how the common designs look from the sub's chair, with the counter. If you build a persona, read it as a list of things to avoid, or to do only with the sub's choice in front.

# Entry designs and their counters

**What they say or do**

1 “Send a small fixed amount and you are in.”

**The counter**

Check the amount against your own cap first. An entry send buys a place in a chat and nothing more.

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**What they say or do**

2 Hidden price, discussed in private.

**The counter**

Ask for the full cost in writing before any send. A hidden price forces you to negotiate blind.

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**What they say or do**

3 Conditions that appear after the first send.

**The counter**

The first send is gone and is not a reason to accept more. Say no to a condition you were not told.

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**What they say or do**

4 Ranks and titles that make belonging depend on spending.

**The counter**

A rank gives you a word. Decide what a word is worth to you before you chase the next one.

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**What they say or do**

5 Pet names and warm words in the same message as a money ask.

**The counter**

Notice when the warmth and the ask arrive together, and answer them in separate steps.

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A persona can be sweet and the design still pull. Watch the order of events, not the tone.

Service roles need terms too. A title such as gen slave or code slave is fair only when the sub chose the scope, can refuse without losing his place, and is thanked. Otherwise it is free labour dressed as devotion. A second dom who works for another dom should get something back, not necessarily money.

## Pace, change and burnout

Domming is mostly written work, seven days a week and always on. Solo builders run the persona, the tools and the community together, and the advice that holds up is plain. Pick one to three things for a day. Finish what is past roughly ten percent before starting something new. Stop measuring yourself against other doms.

Burnout shows as anxiety every time you open the project and a feeling that nothing works. The response is to step back: a few days to a week of not posting, while still answering existing subs. Taking a step back is often right, and you can return. A dom who disappears into building loses trust, because subs need regular contact.

A persona stays composed in front of subs. Keep your private life out of sessions, and keep at least one real person you can talk to, because smiling through pain with nobody to tell is not a plan.

Personas drift. One may change theme, which means the bio, the site and the posts have to be rewritten together, and a hook that no longer fits should be dropped. Looks drift as generators change, so keep old and new images in separate folders and decide case by case which belong to the current look. Studying other personas is useful. Study them, ask before you copy anything, and then differ.

# Keep these

### Why are limits written down?

A limit in the file holds when you are tired and in the middle of a scene.

### What touches real life?

Nothing. Meeting, a camera, a voice and a real name are all refused.

### When is a persona harsh?

When asked. Harshness is a role, and you return to yourself afterwards.

### A sub says money is short.

The money part stops for the evening, and you point outward for help.

# Check yourself

**Question 1 of 3**

### Which of these belongs in the persona file?

- ◯ The sub's real name, kept for safety
- ◯ Written limits, such as no meeting and no camera
- ◯ A promise of refunds

*Answer.* Written limits, such as no meeting and no camera. The file holds the character's rules. Nothing in it identifies a person.

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**Question 2 of 3**

### A condition for membership is first mentioned after the first send. What is it?

- ◯ A normal onboarding step
- ◯ A pressure design
- ◯ A refund policy

*Answer.* A pressure design. A condition that appears after the money moved leaves the sub with a sunk gift and a new demand.

Question 3 of 3

**A persona says she is a pure dom. What does that tell you?**

- ◯ The person behind her is always dominant
- ◯ It is a stage role, which can differ from the person
- ◯ Nothing can be a stage role

*Answer.* It is a stage role, which can differ from the person. A stated role is part of the costume.

## Remember it

1. A persona is a written file: voice, look, limits and marks.
2. Write limits and rules before the first message, not after the first send.
3. Harshness is a role, soft by default and sharp on request.
4. Say every condition before the first send, and show the price.
5. The paid person is never the safety net. Point outward.
6. Keep a pace you can hold, and keep one real person to talk to.

## *Check it*

Every claim with its evidence level and its sources.

### *Evidence levels*

| | |
|---|---|
| Verified | Checked against the original source. |
| Reported | Stated by a serious secondary source read in full. |
| Community | Widely said in the scene; no document proves it. |
| Vivian's field notes | First-hand experience, not a study. |
| Unverified | Plausible, not proven yet. |

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11 See Limits and the wall, below.

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Nothing here is financial, legal or medical advice for your situation.